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Trump leans on executive orders to expand power

Far exceeds his pace in first term as he increasingly tests limits

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

Levying tariffs, setting the ideal water pressure for shower heads, creating the Department of Government Efficiency, confronting anti-Christian bias, deploying the National Guard to Washington, D.C., avoiding the use of “woke AI” in government, and restricting the government’s dealings with certain large law firms.

These are but a sampling of the myriad topics President Trump has attempted to address via executive order within his second term. There are more than 200 others.

An order Monday designating fentanyl as a “a weapon of mass destruction” put him over the top, meaning Trump has issued more executive orders in 2025 than he did during his entire first term, when he signed 220. The sheer volume of Trump’s orders this term are without comparison in recent times. Franklin D. Roosevelt, who famously oversaw an expansion of executive power, is the last president to match Trump’s pace.

Experts on presidential authority said Trump’s frequent use of executive orders reflects not only his ambition to rapidly achieve policy goals, but also his desire to remake the federal government entirely. Trump is testing the limits of executive authority, they said, and potentially setting a new precedent for success.

TRUMP, Page A10

By using cash, savers learn to keep it real

By Dana Gerber
GLOBE STAFF

Cyan Jean is no stranger to the temptations of the increasingly cashless economy.

In the past, the 25-year-old West Roxbury resident grew all too comfortable using Apple Pay on her iPhone to splurge on clothes at Levi’s and H&M or to order Chipotle quesadillas on DoorDash. The transactions were “like a reflex,” she said, and quickly forgotten — until she later checked her bank account and saw the damage done.

So to rein in her spending, she adopted a new strategy: Every two weeks, when she gets her paycheck, she takes out about \$250 in cash. The money, mainly to cover food costs, serves as a visual reminder of how much she’s really spent, helping her get in the habit of thawing a frozen Trader Joe’s meal at home rather than ordering out.

“If I can see it physically in front of me . . . it makes it more real,” said Jean, an administrative assistant at Curry College in Milton. “Whenever I hand the cashier my money and I see the cash in my wallet start to go down, then I’m like, ‘OK, maybe it’s time to slow down a little bit.’”

CASH, Page A7

‘It is extraordinarily rare to be where we are today . . . with no real sense of who did it.’

ADAM LANKFORD, *University of Alabama’s department of criminology and criminal justice*

Still no answers



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Providence police brought in dogs Tuesday at the scene of the shooting, the Barus & Holley Engineering and Physics Building.

Democrats turn up heat on Patel as search continues

By Tal Kopan and Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — As the search for the perpetrator of the fatal shooting at Brown University continues, FBI Director Kash Patel’s handling of the high-profile crime is drawing criticism from Democratic lawmakers.

Patel’s announcement on social media that the FBI had detained a person of interest Sunday, only for that person to be released hours later with seemingly no connection to the attack, echoed a similar miscue in the investigation into the assassination of conservative activist Charlie Kirk in September.

Then on Tuesday, the FBI posted a compilation of security camera footage of the suspect that apparently included home addresses of the people whose footage was collected. The initial social media post was promptly deleted and about an hour later the FBI reposted a version with the addresses removed.

“It’s just a further demonstration of how completely unqualified he is and how he has to be removed from his position,” Massachusetts Senator Ed Markey, a Democrat, said of Patel’s Sunday post about the person in custody. “In this instance, it led people to believe that the culprit had been caught, which reduced everyone’s attention for that time period where, perhaps with a

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PROVIDENCE POLICE

New video from Saturday did not have a clear image of the person of interest’s face.

New video released as police ask residents to check cameras

By Joey Flechas, Amanda Milkovits, Steph Machado, and Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — Authorities have released new video of a man they called a person of interest in the Brown University shooting walking in the neighborhood near campus earlier Saturday before the attack that killed two and injured nine others.

Yet more than three full days since the shooting, police still do not appear close to identifying or apprehending a suspect, nor do they have key information, such as a clear image of the person’s face.

“As I’m out and about, we’re hearing a great deal of anxiety coming from families and students and the general public,” Rhode Island Governor Daniel McKee acknowledged at a Tuesday evening press conference. “That’s one of the

reasons why our State Police has supported Providence schools with presence as school begins and school ends.”

Experts said that every minute counts in an investigation like this, and that it is unusual to have so little information this long after a mass shooting.

“It is extraordinarily rare to be where we are today, four days later, with no real sense of who did it,” said Adam Lankford, chair of the University of Alabama’s department of criminology and criminal justice.

Federal statistics show mass shooters rarely escape capture — most never even leave the crime scene. According to a Globe analysis of FBI reports on active shooter incidents in the US from 2020 to 2024, only six of 227 shooters remained at large. Of the rest, 130 were apprehended by law enforcement, 42 were killed by

BROWN, Page A6

Caution on a person of interest

Police are usually wary of a rush to judgment. A6.



BEN PENNINGTON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

THE FIGHT OF HIS LIFE

As he was being treated for tongue cancer, Kevin Bradley kept coaching boys football and girls basketball at Whittier Regional Vocational Technical High School in Haverhill. He’s received an outpouring of support from students, the school, and the community. At left, he embraced Ricky DiChicco at their Super Bowl this month. B1.

An MIT professor was pronounced dead after being shot at his home in Brookline. B1.

Los Angeles prosecutors said Rob Reiner’s son Nick will be charged with two counts of first-degree murder in the killing of his parents. A2.

Devra First checks out Mr. H in the Seaport and finds the spectacle is the point. G1.

Afghan refugees boost Vt. but crackdown may loom

D.C. shooting brings more restrictions

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

BRATTLEBORO, Vt. — When local officials decided in early 2021 to recruit refugees to this southeastern Vermont town, they imagined a gradual process. Then came the fall of Kabul.

The Taliban’s return to power in Afghanistan that summer prompted the US military to quickly evacuate tens of thousands of allies — and each needed a new home. By the end of 2022, 120 Afghans had relocated to Brattleboro. Since then, hundreds more refugees, asylum-seekers, and other immigrants from more than a dozen countries have moved to the area, reshaping a town of just 12,000 people.

“Our economy is humming,” said Alex Beck, a workforce specialist at the Brattleboro Development Credit Corpo-

ration who helped orchestrate the refugee recruitment. “We have some employers that do not have any vacancies for the first time in years.”

The influx of immigrants has begun to address Vermont’s greatest economic challenge: a stagnant, aging population with too few workers, students, and taxpayers. In Brattleboro, far from the state’s business hub of Burlington, the transformation has been particularly palpable.

“As you go around town, go to the bank, go to the grocery stores and the schools, you see how the community has changed in a positive way,” said Joe Wiah, Vermont director of the Ethiopian Community Development Council, a refugee resettlement agency.

But new restrictions on legal immigration following a deadly shooting in Washington, D.C., in November, could stem the flow of such workers to Vermont and threaten the gains the state

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